PDF forms are not compatible with the Google Chrome PDF viewer plug-in. Chrome users should save the form, then reopen and complete with Adobe reader.

EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

Initially I had hoped to do an essay regarding a new oil field to be developed in the UK. However, I realised that this would not be an appropriate topic, as the deal for the oil field had not gone through yet, so despite my interest, I wouldn't be able to acquire data for my research. After being stumped for awhile, I remembered that I had really enjoyed the concept of government intervention in markets, so I started looking for a suitable topic. I quickly found one that interested me about an new minimum pricing per unit on alcohol in Scotland. Since it was a policy that was already in place, I decided that I would be able to collect appropriate data.

My goal was to gather quantitative data from a reliable source but this proved challenging as I had to decide which sources to use over other sources as there were some inconsistencies between the data sources. I realised that some sources in favour of the policy provided data to support their claims, while those against the policy had some completely different information. I could see that I had to think very critically about the reliability of the information. In the end, I felt that it was appropriate to rely on official government data, but I am not convinced that governments do always present balanced information.

Overall, I believe the extended essay went very well for me as I effectively organised my thoughts through thorough preparation and getting started early on. Starting the research as early as possible was a great choice as I realise now just how many changes I have made throughout the whole journey. If I'd procrastinated, I would have been in trouble, as I wouldn't have had time to really organise my research and analysis to make a good argument. I had plenty of time to really breakdown what I wanted to include and how it contributed to the overall quality of my essay. I believe each section provided value towards answering the research question by providing insightful and often evaluative throughts backed by data, with data being a particularly strong part of the essay. However, I often ask myself I could have gone more in-depth with the essay by making slight alterations to my research question in order to allow me to investigate not only the MUPs effect on alcohol consumption, but also the wider implications of excessive alcohol consumption and alcohol-related incidents such as hospital admissions.

Although it seemed very scary at first, I am very glad that I have completed this assignment. I have learned how to do thorough research, critically evaluate my sources and develop an argument using economic theory. I have also learned about referencing and presenting a bibliography. The approach used here will be useful for any research assignments I might have at university.

(476 words)

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